

Performance Max (PMax) Optimization Checklist

Use this checklist to ensure your campaigns are set up for success.



1. Have a strong budget

- It's best to use targets to control your spend
- Use budget estimator, compare historical budgets and performance
- Budget suggestions for new campaigns for PMax are available in campaign creation.

2. Structure your campaign(s)

- Create separate campaigns for different countries, languages, budgets, or ROAS targets.
- Use asset groups for bundle assets in themes, audience signals, or product categories.
- For short-term promotions, set up promotion-specific asset groups and upload assets at least one day before your promotion starts.

3. Add as many signals + data as possible

- Add audience signals and search themes to your asset groups, search themes will not limit your volume.
- Add micro-conversions (e.g., add-to-cart, sign-ups) to provide more data for the algorithm.
- Import offline conversions frequently, especially for call-heavy or service-based campaigns.

4. Feed & Creative Optimization (for retail)

- Ensure store is associated and product feeds are accurate, complete, and relevant.

5. Smart Bidding Strategies

- Use CPA/ROAS targets to control spend, not just budget caps.
- Make large target changes gradually (~15% increments) to avoid volatility.
- Apply seasonality adjustments for short-term sales events (e.g., Cyber Weekend).

6. Monitor Performance

- Account for conversion delays when analyzing results.
- Leverage asset group and audience insights reporting, and watch out for channel performance reporting for more transparency.

7. Expand Reach & Awareness

- Combine search and PMax with audience ads for incremental reach and new user acquisition with a more customized strategy
- Use multiple asset types (text, image, feed-based ads to maximize engagement across placements, including Copilot

8. Audience Targeting

- Understand your true purchasing audience and tailor campaigns for market and generational differences.

9. Compliance & Sensitive Verticals

- Check for restrictions on sensitive queries (e.g., healthcare) and follow Microsoft guidelines.

10. Leverage Partner Resources

- Use the Partner Portal and Agency Center for onboarding, support, and campaign management.
- Join the exclusive LinkedIn Partner Group for expert feedback and community support.
- Access online help documentation for troubleshooting and advanced setup.



Pro Tips

Account for a two-week learning period: Patience with learning and data are key to success.

Stay Updated: Watch for new features such as uplift experiments and vertical ad support.

Share Feedback: Use surveys and partner channels to request new features and share your experience.